themselves over to the police. This was a remarkable design. Had Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt decided that they would flee, Bhagat Singh could still have escaped the gallows, if such a stratagem had been successful. Yet, they had deliberately chosen not to do so. The reason is that Bhagat Singh wanted an opportunity to make a speech to the court highlighting their political grievances and thereby giving the HSRA the publicity it needed at this point. Just throwing printed leaflets, with statements inscribed on them, in a smoke-filled legislative chamber was not enough. The insurgents also wanted the opportunity to make an oral statement, which would be widely reported, in open court before a judge tried them.

For this reason, Bhagat Singh and his co-conspirator, B.K. Dutt, deliberately chose to throw the smoke bombs, from the vantage point of the visitors' gallery, on the right side of the speaker, because they knew that they could cause no casualties. They wished only to frighten. And, so they did. The smoke bombs were followed by the firing of two shots from a small pistol in the air. This calculated act had the desired effect of Bhagat Singh and B.K Dutt drawing immediate and prompt attention to themselves from the men on the floor of the assembly below, as they looked up in shock and disbelief. The two of them then pointedly showered their home-made HSRA leaflets upon the panic-stricken assembly members below. It was a frightening spectacle for all involved. At about 12.30 p.m., a bluish smoke arose from the centre of the chamber of the Legislative Assembly. The traffic inspector immediately gave the order that visitors should be prevented from leaving the gallery. Just then another explosion took place. This time smoke appeared from the chamber below the ladies' gallery. Two pistol shots were fired in quick succession soon afterwards. People rushed frantically to the exit door. Some, pointing to the central door, exclaimed, 'There they are.' But Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt were not there. They were in the public gallery midway between the central door and the ladies' gallery. They were heard shouting, 'Down with imperialism.' When arrested, neither offered any resistance whatsoever, even though Bhagat Singh was allegedly seen 'gesticulating with a pistol in his right hand'. When searched, Bhagat Singh had some newspapers and pamphlets on his